DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 6

Photoshop expert

Profession 6 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A Photoshop expert uses Adobe Photoshop at a high level: complex compositing, retouching, mockups, automation with actions and templates, and print preparation.

What professionals do every day

Builds layered compositions, creates reusable templates and actions, delivers mockups, prepares print files and trains teams on the software.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Agencies and brands need reliable, fast production. An expert builds templates and actions that save hours on every project.

- Repetitive tasks done by hand.
- Mockups that look fake.
- Files that are hard for others to edit.

Skills you need

- Layers, masks, smart objects and blend modes.
- Selection and retouching techniques.
- Actions and templates.
- Print preparation: CMYK, bleed, resolution.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Adobe Photoshop	Professional image editing	Trial	Subscription	www.adobe.com/products/photoshop.html
Photopea	Browser-based editor that reads PSD files	Free with ads	Paid removal of ads	www.photopea.com
Adobe Photoshop tutorials	Official learning	Free	Free	helpx.adobe.com/photoshop.html

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Build a layered poster with masks.
Intermediate	Create a product mockup with a smart object.
Advanced	Record an action that resizes a set of files.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Mockup pack for a product line.
- **Intermediate:** Social template system.
- **Advanced:** Print-ready event poster.

Client-ready portfolio project

A reusable mockup template and an action set for a fictional brand, with a layer-naming guide so another designer can edit the file.

Worked example

Worked example. A smart object holds the client's screenshot. Replacing the image updates every mockup at once; the file keeps the layers named and grouped.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Template with smart objects and an action

Business problem: A brand wants mockups it can update without a designer.

Steps

1. Build the mockup with a smart object for the screen.
2. Name and group every layer.
3. Record an action that exports three sizes.
4. Test by replacing the screen image.

Expected output: A template, an action and a short editing guide.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

The smart object keeps the replacement non-destructive. Named layers and groups make the file usable by others. The action removes the repetitive export step.

Common mistakes

- Destroying originals by editing pixels directly.
- Unnamed layers that nobody can follow.
- Mockups with lighting that does not match the scene.
- Giving clients unlocked files with no guide.

Freelancing opportunities

- Template and mockup systems for brands.
- Print and packaging preparation.
- Briefs for 'Photoshop', 'mockup', 'photo compositing'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Adobe Photoshop help and tutorials

Part of **Master Freelancing: Design and Creative**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full textbook. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.